2027 Rural Ordinary Election

Operational Manual for Returning Officers and Assistant Returning Officers

Issued by Home Affairs Department
October 2026

Table of Contents

.....PAGE

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS 1

LIST OF SPECIFIED/STANDARD FORMS 2

CHAPTER 1: EXECUTIVE SUMMARY 5

CHAPTER 2: BEFORE POLLING 7

PART I IDENTIFYING AND ALLOCATING DESIGNATED SPOTS FOR ELECTION ADVERTISEMENTS ("EAS") 7

PART II NOMINATION OF CANDIDATES 8

PART III VALIDITY OF NOMINATIONS 18

PART IV CORRESPONDENCE ADDRESSES OF CANDIDATES 23

PART V CAMPAIGNING ACTIVITIES 23

PART VI NO CANVASSING ZONE ("NCZ") AND NO STAYING ZONE ("NSZ") 25

PART VII CANDIDATE FORMS 27

PART VIII SUBMISSION OF COPIES OF EAS AND RELEVANT INFORMATION 28

PART IX APPOINTMENT OF ELECTION, POLLING COUNTING AND ELECTION EXPENSE AGENTS 32

PART X COMPLAINTS HANDLING 35

PART XI PUBLIC INSPECTION OF DOCUMENTS 35

PART XII ESSENTIAL SERVICES TO BE PROVIDED DURING ORDINARY BUSINESS HOURS 36

PART XIII RE-ALLOCATION OF POLLING STATION FOR ELECTOR WITH A DISABILITY 37

PART XIV EXIT POLL 37

CHAPTER 3: POLLING 40

PART I THE POLL 40

PART II POSTPONEMENT OR ADJOURNMENT OF THE POLL OR THE COUNT 42

CHAPTER 4: COUNTING.....44

PART I BPSS AND COUNTING STATION 44

PART II "FIRST PAST THE POST" VOTING SYSTEM 45

PART III ELECTION RESULT 45

CHAPTER 5: AFTER POLLING.....50

PART I MAXIMUM AMOUNT OF ELECTION EXPENSES.....50

PART II RETURN AND DECLARATION OF ELECTION EXPENSES AND ELECTION DONATIONS 50

PART III SUBMISSION OF RURAL REPRESENTATIVE OATH 52

PART IV DISPOSAL OF ELECTORAL DOCUMENTS.....53

PART V CONFIRMATION OF DESTRUCTION OF RELEVANT ELECTORS' INFORMATION 53

ACTION CHECKLIST FOR RETURNING OFFICER 55

Appendices:

APPENDIX I	DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF RETURNING OFFICERS, ASSISTANT RETURNING OFFICERS AND ASSISTANT RETURNING OFFICERS(LEGAL)
APPENDIX II	CONTACT TELEPHONE NUMBER AND FAX NUMBER OF GOVERNMENT DEPARTMENTS AND RELEVANT PARTIES (FOR INTERNAL REFERENCE)
APPENDIX III	ACTION CHECKLIST FOR PROCESSING NOMINATION FORM
APPENDIX IV	CIVIL SERVICE BUREAU CIRCULAR NO. 5/2014
APPENDIX V	HAD STANDING CIRCULAR NO. 6/2014
APPENDIX VI	CHECKLIST FOR VETTING GRID PAPER SUBMITTED BY CANDIDATE
APPENDIX VII	NOTES TO CANDIDATES
APPENDIX VIII	CONTINGENCY PLANS IN RESPECT OF THE DEATH OR DISQUALIFICATION OF A VALIDLY NOMINATED CANDIDATE BEFORE OR ON THE POLLING DAY
APPENDIX IX	ACTION CHECKLIST FOR CANDIDATES
APPENDIX X	SUBMISSION METHODS OF CANDIDATE FORMS
APPENDIX XI	PROCEDURAL GUIDE ON SUBMISSION OF ELECTION ADVERTISEMENTS ONTO THE CENTRAL PLATFORM
APPENDIX XII	PROCEDURAL GUIDE ON USING CENTRAL PLATFORM (FOR RETURNING OFFICER)
APPENDIX XIII	SAMPLE NOTE FOR COVER OF ELECTION ADVERTISEMENTS FOLDER
APPENDIX XIV	PERIOD/DEADLINES FOR THE COLLECTION, SUBMISSION AND INSPECTION OF CANDIDATES' FORMS FOR RURAL COMMITTEE WITH RURAL REPRESENTATIVE ELECTION(S)
APPENDIX XV	INSPECTION OF ELECTORAL FORMS OR DOCUMENTS
APPENDIX XVI	INSPECTION OF THE INFORMATION SHEETS AND COPIES OF ELECTION ADVERTISEMENTS
APPENDIX XVII	CONTINGENCY PLANS FOR INCLEMENT WEATHER OR EMERGENCIES AFFECTING THE SET-UP, THE POLL AND THE COUNTING OF VOTES
APPENDIX XVIII	RETURNING OFFICER’S SCRIPT - ANNOUNCEMENT OF ELECTION RESULT
APPENDIX XIX	CONTACT LOG WITH CANDIDATE FOR SUBMISSION OF RETURN AND DECLARATION OF ELECTION EXPENSES AND ELECTION DONATIONS

List of abbreviations

APS	Alternative Polling Station
ARO	Assistant Returning Officer
BPSS	Ballot Paper Sorting Station
CAS	Civil Aid Services
CCC	Central Command Centre
CCS	Commissioner of Correctional Services
CSB	Civil Service Bureau
CSD	Correctional Services Department
DCC	District Command Centre
DHA	Director of Home Affairs
DO	District Office
DoJ	Department of Justice
DPRO	Deputy Presiding Officer
DPS	Dedicated Polling Station
EA	Election Advertisement
EAC	Electoral Affairs Commission
FEHD	Food and Environmental Hygiene Department
GLD	Government Logistics Department
HAD	Home Affairs Department
HAD HQs	Home Affairs Department Headquarters
HAEC	Home Affairs Enquiry Centre
HD	Housing Department
ICAC	Independent Commission Against Corruption
IIR	Indigenous Inhabitant Representative
KFR	Kaifong Representative
LandsD	Lands Department
LCSD	Leisure and Cultural Services Department
LEA	Law Enforcement Agency
NCZ	No Canvassing Zone
NSZ	No Staying Zone
ORO	Official Receiver's Officer
para., paras.	Paragraph, paragraphs
PRO	Presiding Officer
RC	Rural Committee
REO	Registration and Electoral Office
ReR	Resident Representative
RO	Returning Officer
RRE	Rural Representative Election
RREMIS	Rural Representative Election Management Information System
s., ss.,	Section, sections
SHYA	Secretary for Home and Youth Affairs

List of specified/standard forms

Form No.	**Name of specified / standard forms**
HAD/R2	Daily Return on the Number of Nomination Form Received
HAD/R3	提名是否有效的決定通知書 (給有關候選人) Notice of Decision as to Validity of Nomination (To the Candidate Concerned)
HAD/R4	提名是否有效的決定通知書 (給其他候選人) Notice of Decision as to Validity of Nomination (To Other Candidates)
HAD/R5	Notice of Withdrawal of Candidature (To Government Departments)
HAD/R6	候選人退出競選的通知 (給其他候選人) Notice of Withdrawal of Candidature (To Other Candidates)
HAD/R7	選票上候選人編號的通知 Notice of the Candidate Number on the Ballot Paper
HAD/R8	選舉代理人詳情公告 Notice of Particulars of Election Agents
HAD/R9	禁止拉票區及禁止逗留區公告 Notice of No Canvassing Zone and No Staying Zone
HAD/R10	更改禁止拉票區及禁止逗留區公告 Notice of Variation of No Canvassing Zone and No Staying Zone
HAD/R11	Authorization to Make or Amend Notice of No Canvassing Zone and No Staying Zone
HAD/R12	於投票站／禁止拉票區／禁止逗留區驅逐他人的授權 Authorization for Removal of Person from Polling Station or No Canvassing Zone or No Staying Zone
HAD/R13	進入點票區的准許書 Permission for Admission into the Counting Zone

Form No.	**Name of specified / standard forms**
HAD/R14	於點票站驅逐他人的授權 Authorization for Removal of Person from Counting Station
HAD/R14/BPSS	於選票分流站驅逐他人的授權 Authorization for Removal of Person from Ballot Paper Sorting Station
HAD/R15	點票及選票分流時間及地點公告 Notice of the Time and Place of the Count and Sorting of Ballot Papers
HAD/R16	押後點票時間及地點公告 Notice of the Time and Place of a Postponed Counting of Votes
HAD/R16/BPSS	押後選票分流時間及地點公告 Notice of the Time and Place of a Postponed Sorting of Ballot Papers
HAD/R17	於*投票站／選票分流站／點票站的點票區內*拍影片／拍照／錄音／錄影的准許 Permission for *Filming/Taking Photographs/Making Audio or Video Recording within the *Polling Station/Ballot Paper Sorting Station/Counting Zone of the Counting Station
HAD/R18	進入投票站的准許書 Permission for Admission into the Polling Station
HAD/R19	拆除在禁止拉票區內展示的選舉廣告通知書 Notice on Removal of Election Advertisements (“EAs”) Displayed within No Canvassing Zone (“NCZ”)

Form No.	**Name of specified / standard forms**
HAD/R20	認收通知書 (就位於懲教院所內的專用投票站（高度設防監獄除外）委任監察投票代理人通知書及選舉代理人／監察投票代理人在位於懲教院所內的專用投票站內停留的同意申請書（高度設防監獄除外）) Acknowledgement Receipt (Notice of Appointment of Polling Agent for a Dedicated Polling Station Situated in a Penal Institution (Other than a Maximum Security Prison) and Application for Consent to the Presence of Election Agent/Polling Agent in a Dedicated Polling Station Situated in a Penal Institution (Other than a Maximum Security Prison))
HAD/R21	Notification of Submission of Hard Copy Election Advertisement by the Candidate
HAD/R22	提交選舉開支及接受選舉捐贈之申報書及聲明書 Submission of Return and Declaration of Election Expenses and Election Donations
HAD/R23	Request for Removal of Election Advertisements posted on the Central Platform
HAD/R24	移除選舉廣告決定通知書 Notice of Decision as to Removal of Election Advertisement
HAD/R25	遞交候選人提名表格注意事項 Points to Note for Submission of Nomination Forms for Candidates
HAD/R26	承諾書 Undertaking Form

Chapter 1: Executive Summary

The mandate of the Returning Officer/ Assistant Returning Officer is to assist the Electoral Affairs Commission in safeguarding the integrity of the Election and to ensure that all electoral procedures are conducted in accordance with the law in an open, fair and honest manner.

1.1. To carry out the duties of the RO or ARO, you should study thoroughly the relevant provisions of the following ordinances and regulations, which provide you with a legal basis on which you discharge your duties, and the Guidelines on Election-related Activities in respect of the RRE ("**Guidelines**")–

- Rural Representative Election Ordinance (Cap. 576)
- Rural Representative (Election Petition) Rules (Cap. 576B)
- Electoral Procedure (Rural Representative Election) Regulation (Cap. 541L)
- Elections (Corrupt and Illegal Conduct) Ordinance (Cap. 554)
- Maximum Amount of Election Expenses (Rural Representative Election) Regulation (Cap. 554B)

1.2. This manual details the practical electoral arrangements at the operational level and highlights some major points that serve as a reminder to you. ***You should refer to the respective ordinances, regulations and guidelines where appropriate.***

1.3. In case of doubt when discharging your duties, you may seek advice from the DoJ (Attn.: Ms. Jenny LAW, Senior Government Counsel) and copy your request to the HAD HQs as appropriate. You may also seek such advice from the DoJ through the HAD HQs.

1.4. As the RO, you may delegate to the ARO(s) the power to perform any of the duties, **except –**

(a) the determination of validity of nominations;
(b) the declaration of election result; and
(c) the determination of validity of questionable ballot papers^.

A duty list of ROs and AROs is at **Appendix I**.

1.5. ROs, AROs and any other persons appointed/recruited for the purpose of conducting an election must comply with EAC's directives and instructions.

1.6. To facilitate effective and efficient communication, the contact numbers of relevant parties are provided at **Appendix II** for your quick reference.

Note The contact numbers of relevant parties should be for internal use only and should not be disclosed to the public.

Ss.78 and 79 of Cap. 541L stipulate that an RO, ARO, PRO, polling officer or counting officer who, in an election for which he or she is appointed, may not act as an agent* or shall not be an employee of a candidate.

RO/ARO should pay special attention to these provisions to avoid committing any act which contravenes the above provisions.

* An agent includes an election agent, a polling agent, a counting agent and an election expense agent.

^ Following the established practice, for KFR Election, the RO(s) appointed for the relevant Market Towns will be required to determine the validity of questionable ballot papers; for VR Election, the determination will be made by the relevant PROs appointed for the respective Villages.

Chapter 2: Before Polling

- **Identifying and allocating designated spots for election advertisements (Guidelines, Ch. 7)**
- **Processing nominations (Guidelines, Ch. 3)**
- **Determining validity of nominations (Guidelines, Ch. 3)**
- **Sending correspondence to candidates' correspondence addresses (including the notice of validity of nominations)**
- **Monitoring campaigning activities (Guidelines, Ch. 7 and 8)**
- **Determining No Canvassing Zone and No Staying Zone (Guidelines, Ch. 13)**
- **Receiving forms from candidates**
- **Receiving copies of election advertisements and relevant information from candidates (Guidelines, Ch. 7)**
- **Receiving and processing appointments of election, polling, counting, and election expense agents (Guidelines, Ch.6)**
- **Handling complaints (Guidelines, Ch. 19)**
- **Making available documents for public inspection**
- **Providing essential services during ordinary business hours**

Part I Identifying and allocating designated spots for election advertisements ("EAs")

2.1. You should identify suitable designated spots at public places within the Rural Area and obtain prior approval from the relevant government departments before the start of the nomination period (i.e. **before 24 November 2026**).

2.2. You should co-ordinate with relevant government departments to clear all unauthorized displays at the designated spots to

ensure that clearance is completed before the allocation of designated spots (i.e. before the EAC Briefing for Candidates on **14 December 2026**).

2.3. Chapter 7 "Election Advertisements" of the **Guidelines** and "Action Checklist regarding Designation, Allocation and Enforcement in respect of Display of Election Advertisements" issued by the HAD HQs provide you as well as parties concerned with detailed procedures regarding the identification and allocation of designated spots for EAs.

2.4. No designated spot will be allocated to a candidate in an uncontested rural area or a candidate who indicates he/she does not wish to display EAs at designated spots.

Part II Nomination of candidates

2.5. The Action Checklist for Processing Nomination Form is at **Appendix III**.

Receiving nomination forms

2.6. Within the nomination period (i.e. **from 24 November to 7 December 2026**), you should receive Nomination Forms during ordinary business hours: between **9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m.** on any Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday or Friday (other than a general holiday) and between **9:00 a.m. and 12:00 noon** on Saturday (other than a general holiday) at the RO's office.

2.7. No Nomination Form should be accepted after 5:00 p.m. on the closing day, i.e. **7 December 2026 (Monday)**.

2.8. If the last day of the nomination period falls on an inclement weather warning day (a working day on which a gale warning, i.e. any of the tropical cyclone warning signals commonly referred to as Nos. 8, 9 and 10 issued by the Hong Kong Observatory, or a black rainstorm warning is in force at any time

during ordinary business hours), the nomination period would be extended to end on the next working day (including Saturday) which is not an inclement weather warning day. For example, if typhoon signal No. 8 is in force from 10:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. on **7 December 2026**, the deadline of submitting nomination forms would be extended to 5:00 p.m. on **8 December 2026**.

2.9. You should display a notice, which will be provided by HAD HQs, in the lobby or entrance of your office, NTHAECs, NTDO Notice Boards at Rural Areas concerned, if any, and copy to the Rural Committees concerned to notify the date and time for receiving nomination forms. Please also display the "Points to Note for Submission of Nomination Forms for Candidates" (HAD/R25) in the lobby or entrance of your office.

2.10. Each Nomination Form must be lodged by the candidate **in person** at the RO's office, except with the express permission of the RO.

> ***Note*** You may, in exceptional circumstances (e.g. candidate's temporary absence from Hong Kong or incapacity due to illness, etc.), permit the submission of the nomination form in any other manner. Such request should be taken into account on a case by case basis. You may seek legal advice from the DoJ, where necessary.

2.11. You should arrange copies of the Nomination Forms to be made available for public inspection during ordinary business hours (please see the definition of "ordinary business hours" in paragraph 2.91 below) as soon as practicable after you have received them until the publication of the election results in the Gazette. You should cover all identity document types and numbers, date of birth (except the year), addresses, principal residential addresses ("PRAs") (except the Region, District and Name of Rural Area) (for ReR and KFR elections only), correspondence address, telephone number(s), fax number and email address (except contact information for the media

and public inspection) on the nomination form before display for compliance with the Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance ("PDPO") (Cap. 486).

2.12. For ReR and KFR elections, members of the public may wish to inspect the complete PRA of the candidates and/or subscribers with a view to checking their eligibility. Subject to your approval, you should ask them to sign an Undertaking Form (HAD/R26) to undertake not to use any of the information so obtained for any purposes unrelated to the election.

Processing Nomination Forms

2.13. You should designate an officer to help you check the following in particular before you send the candidate away –

(a) the Nomination Form (including the declaration) has been signed by the candidate;

(b) the name of candidate tallies with that shown on his/her identity document (being the identity document based on which the particulars of the candidate are recorded in the Final Register of the relevant rural area). If you are satisfied that a candidate is usually known by a name different from that shown on his/her identity document, you may allow him/her to include that name in the field of "Alias" in his/her nomination form;

(c) the candidate has reached 21 years of age (by referring to the Date of Birth shown on his/her Hong Kong Identity Card);

(d) the candidate is a **Hong Kong permanent resident** (by referring to his/her Hong Kong Identity Card to see whether there are the wordings – "**HONG KONG PERMANENT IDENTITY CARD, 香港永久性居民身份證**";

(e) to facilitate the publication of the Notice of Valid

Nominations and other specified notices in the Government Gazette, the Nomination Form must include in both Chinese and English;

i. the candidate's name and address (for IIR election);
ii. the candidate's name and PRA (for ReR and KFR elections);

(f) A candidate for IIR election can fill in his/her office or business address, correspondence address, residential address or post office box number as address. For ReR and KFR elections, the candidate must provide the complete PRA, but only the region, district and name of rural area of the candidate's PRA will be listed in the relevant notice(s). If the candidate does not know how to complete the English or Chinese address, you may ask him/her to provide the electricity bill or other documents which show his/her English/Chinese address. Your attention is hereby drawn to s.8 of the Cap. 541L which provides that the RO may, at the request of the candidate, give assistance in preparing the nomination form;

(g) the Nomination Form has been **signed by a witness** (other than the candidate);

(h) the Nomination Form should be subscribed by at least **5 registered electors** of the relevant Rural Area. A candidate should not sign as a subscriber in his/her nomination form. An elector for a Rural Area can only subscribe the specified number of Nomination Forms. The specified number of Nomination Forms means the number of nomination forms that is equivalent to the number of RRs to be returned for the Rural Area at the Election. If, however, the nomination subscribed by an elector has been ruled invalid, he/she may subscribe another one instead before the end of the nomination period. To avoid the risk of invalidation of the nomination due to disqualification of subscriber, the Nomination Form

may be subscribed by more than 5 subscribers. If there are more than 10 subscribers, the **Supplementary Sheet for Subscribers** must be used;

(i) the Nomination Form must be signed by each subscriber, and he/she must provide the name and identity document number as shown on his/her identity document (being the identity document based on which the particulars of the subscriber are recorded in the Final Register). For ReR and KFR elections, the subscriber should also provide the complete PRA;

(j) conduct a preliminary checking via the RREMIS;

- to see whether the candidate and his/her subscribers are registered electors of the Rural Area for which the candidate is nominated;

- for ReR and KFR elections, to see whether the PRA of the candidate and subscribers on the Nomination Form tally with those shown on the Final Register; and

(k) the candidate can obtain from you a list of general locations of the designated spots, which may include unleased government land and premises managed by the government authorities available for allocation to the candidates for a particular Rural Area.

2.14. You have to draw the candidate's attention to all the circumstances set out in ss.22, 23 and 24 of Cap. 576 under which a candidate is eligible for or is disqualified from being nominated as a candidate and from being elected as a Rural Representative respectively when he/she submits the Nomination Form. An extract from the relevant sections is shown on the **Notes on Completion of Nomination Form for the Rural Ordinary Election** attached to the nomination form.

Note Your attention is drawn to the footnote 1 (for ReR/KFR election) or footnote 2 (for IIR election) on the nomination form in respect of the Court of First Instance judgment of 21 June 2012 on Wong Hin Wai v Secretary for Justice (HCAL 51/2012) and Leung Kwok Hung v Secretary for Justice (HCAL 54/2012) regarding the constitutionality of s.39(1)(b) of the Legislative Council Ordinance (which is similar to s.23(1)(b) of Cap. 576). The Government announced its decision not to appeal against the judgment. If you are doubtful about a candidate's eligibility for nomination, you should seek advice from the HAD HQs or the DoJ.

2.15. If the candidate is a civil servant, his/her attention should also be drawn to the **CSB Circular No. 5/2014** which states that civil servants may seek candidature and election to the RR office provided that they have obtained prior permission from their Permanent Secretary/Head of Department. It also states that permission will not normally be granted to certain categories of civil servants. Please refer to the circular at **Appendix IV** for more details. If the candidate is a civil servant of HAD, please also refer to the HAD Standing Circular No. 6/2014 at **Appendix V**.

2.16. You have to give a Candidate's Folder to each candidate and ask him/her to -

(1) lodge with you **as early as possible before the end of nomination period** (i.e. by 5:00 p.m. on **7 December 2026**) the duly completed **–**

- Grid Paper (HAD/C17a) affixing a colour photograph of the candidate which must be in a specified size and taken within the last 6 months; and provide 2 additional copies of his/her photograph identical to the one affixed to the grid paper. Each of the two identical photos should be affixed with name labels to the back with the name of candidate in both Chinese and English (unless

not applicable), and the name of the RC and Rural Area. For details, please see the "**Checklist for Vetting Grid Paper Submitted by Candidate**" and "**Guidelines on Processing Grid Paper**" at **Appendix VI**;

- "Intention to Display Election Advertisements at Designated Spots" (HAD/C21) if he/she wishes to display election advertisements at designated spots. Only contesting candidates will be allocated with designated spots. You will allocate the designated spots to the contesting candidates by the drawing of lots;

Note Please remind the candidates that if they do not hand in the duly completed grid paper (HAD/C17a) before the end of the nomination period, only their names and candidate numbers would be printed on the "Introduction to Candidates". Requests for correction/addition to grid papers will not be entertained after the close of nomination period. If the grid paper contains any content in a language other than Chinese and English, please ask the candidate to enclose the translation of such content in order to ensure that it contains materials relating only to the candidature of the candidate at this Election (the translation will NOT be included in the leaflet).

(2) submit a request for collecting a hard copy and/or a soft copy of an extract of the Final Register which contains the names, principal residential addresses and correspondence addresses (if any) of the electors of the relevant Rural Area and their email addresses (if the electors concerned have provided such email addresses to the HAD for the purpose of receiving election mails from candidates) by completing the reply slip of the "Notice for Collection of Electors' Information" ("HAD/C16") ("Notice") and signing the "Undertaking on the Proper Use of Electors' Information" ("HAD/C16a") ("Undertaking"). To avoid wastage and safeguard data privacy, please ask the candidate to consider carefully the

need for the above item(s). When the candidate has been decided as validly nominated, you should inform the candidate or his/her election agent by telephone to collect the item(s) at the RO's office. The candidate must submit the original of the Undertaking. If candidates or their election agents submitted the Notice by email or facsimile, they can sign the Undertaking when they collect the elector's information in person. You should also remind the candidate to duly destroy the item(s) within 2 weeks after the election and return the duly completed "Reply Slip on Confirmation of Destruction of Relevant Electors' Information" (HAD/C16b) to you within two weeks after the election;

(3) submit the "**Form for Submission of a Text Version of Introduction to Candidates for Electors with Visual Impairment**" by email to rre@had.gov.hk by **5:00 p.m. on 21 December 2026** (Monday) for production of a text version of Introduction to Candidates for uploading onto the RRE website. Candidates are strongly encouraged to do so to communicate their electoral messages to persons with visual impairment;

(4) attend a lots drawing session held by the RO/ARO on **11 December 2026** (or a date as specified by the RO) at the designated time and venue arranged by the relevant District Office for determining the candidate number to be shown on the ballot paper and the allocation of designated spots for candidates' display of election advertisements;

(5) attend the "EAC Briefing for Candidates" on **14 December 2026** at 7:30 p.m. at the Yuen Chau Kok Community Hall, 35 Ngan Shing Street, Sha Tin, New Territories. The invitation letter for the Lots Drawing Session and EAC Briefing for Candidates is included in the Candidate's Folder; and

(6) attend a session of Checking of Ballot Paper, Introduction to Candidates and Poster Printing Proofs by Candidates on 17 – 21 December 2026 or at a time as specified by RO (with one clear day advance notice as far as possible). If a

candidate or his/her election agent cannot perform the checking in person, the candidate may authorize a representative to check the printing proofs on his/her behalf. If a candidate or his/her election agent/authorized representative does not perform the checking at the specified date and venue, the printing proofs will be printed without further notice.

2.17. You have to give the candidate(s) the "**Notes to Candidates**" at **Appendix VII** to remind him/her of the important points to note upon submission of nomination form. You may also use the notes as a sample script if you consider it suitable to also convey the information verbally.

2.18. When you are satisfied with the nomination, you should stamp the receipt date and time on the nomination form. After that, you may send the candidate away.

> ***Note*** The Nomination Form should not be accepted if any of the required information has not been provided to your satisfaction. However, for nominations received at the last minute of the nomination period, you are advised to stamp the receipt of nomination form first before going through the procedures mentioned in paragraphs 2.13 to 2.18 above. This is because you do **not** have the power to accept any nomination form after the end of the nomination period (5:00 p.m. on **7 December 2026**), but you can always accept a nomination form first and then decide whether it is valid or invalid afterwards.

2.19. You should also fill in the information (including Nomination No., Submission Date, Submission Time, Rural Committee Code and Village Code) in the box shown at the top of the front page of the nomination form.

Informing HAD HQs

2.20. Upon completing the receipt process of each nomination, you

should **immediately** input the candidate's information and scan the copy of following documents into RREMIS:

(a) Nomination Form (pages 1 to 8);
(b) Supplementary Sheet for Subscribers (if any); and
(c) Hong Kong Identity Card (please insert the HKIC into a cover, which will be provided by HAD HQs, showing only Chinese name and English name of the candidate before making a photocopy).

2.21. You should generate the form "**Daily Return on the Number of Nomination Form Received**" (HAD/R2) from the RREMIS and send it by email to Miss Ronnie LI, LO(1)11 (email address: Ronnie HY LI/HAD/HKSARG@HAD) and copy to Miss Joey LUI, LO(1)5B (email address: Joey YT LUI/HAD/HKSARG@HAD), and Miss Malina LEE, PM(1)3 (email address: Malina FO LEE/HAD/HKSARG@HAD) and Ms. Alison CHEUNG, PCO(1)10 (email address: Alison KS CHEUNG/HAD/HKSARG@HAD) by 6:00 p.m. (from Monday to Friday) or by 12:30 p.m. (on Saturday) on a daily basis during the nomination period (i.e. from **24 November to 7 December 2026**). Please note that **nil return is required**.

2.22. You should update the Candidate Nomination Table daily and send it to "&HAD/RRE Web Maint". For details, please refer to the email under the heading of "Action Guide on Posting of List of Candidates Nominated onto Rural Representative Election Website".

2.23. You should send the completed Grid Papers (with one colour photograph affixed) together with another 2 identical colour photographs (with the name label affixed on the back) **by hand** to Ms. Alison CHEUNG, PCO(1)10 or Miss Malina LEE, PM(1)3, Team 2, Div 1, HAD HQs (Address: Room 2108, 21/F, Immigration Tower, 7 Gloucester Road, Wan Chai) by 11:00 a.m., each day (Mondays to Fridays) from **25 November to 8 December 2026** if you receive any submission of Grid Paper from the candidates. For details, please see the "Guidelines on Processing Grid Paper" at Annex A to **Appendix VI**.

2.24. After submission of their Nomination Forms, candidates may wish to revise their particulars provided in the forms. Such revision may be allowed before the end of the nomination period and before you make a decision on the validity of the nomination concerned. The revised form should be scanned into the RREMIS.

Withdrawal of candidature

2.25. Candidate may withdraw his/her nomination by completing a "**Notice of Withdrawal of Candidature**", (HAD/C5) which must be delivered to you before the close of nomination period by the candidate in person or by his/her election agent, if appointed, in person.

2.26. When you receive the withdrawal notice, you should complete and send the "**Notice of Withdrawal of Candidature**" (HAD/R5) to notify the government departments concerned and the other validly nominated candidate(s) of the Rural Area concerned (HAD/R6).

2.27. You should fax to the HAD HQs and REO the notification (HAD/R5) as soon as possible but in any case not later than 6:00 p.m. on weekday and 12:30 p.m. on Saturday upon receipt of the withdrawal notice.

2.28. You should update the Candidate Nomination Table in the RRE website and send it to "&HAD/RRE Web Maint".

Part III Validity of Nominations

Verification of candidate's eligibility

2.29. Upon receiving the scanned nomination form, the HAD HQs will verify the following –

(a) whether the candidate is a registered elector of the Rural

Area for which he/she is nominated;

(b) whether the candidate has been nominated for more than one Rural Area in the election;

(c) whether a subscriber is qualified to subscribe the nomination form (e.g. whether he/she is a registered elector of the relevant Rural Area, and whether he/she has subscribed the nomination forms which exceed the number of vacancies to be returned for the Rural Area);

(d) in liaison with the Police, whether the candidate has any criminal record;

(e) in liaison with the ORO, whether the candidate has any bankruptcy order; and

(f) in liaison with the CSD (if appropriate), whether the candidate has any record of imprisonment under supervision at the time of nominations.

2.30. The above checking will normally take 3 days. In the last 2 or 3 days of the nomination period, the HAD HQs will make special arrangement with the Police, the ORO, and the CSD (if appropriate) to speed up the checking process, if necessary. To ensure timely completion of the above checking, you should scan the Nomination Form into the RREMIS promptly.

(In view of the likelihood that nomination forms might "flood in" near the end of the nomination period in particular in the last two days, you should liaise with the HAD HQs in advance if it is anticipated that there will be a considerable number of nomination forms to be submitted to the HAD HQs for processing so that appropriate prior arrangement can be made with the Police / ORO.)

Validity of nomination

2.31. Chapter 3 "Nomination of Candidates" of the **Guidelines** provides useful advice to help you decide the validity of the nomination(s).

2.32. In case of doubt, you may seek advice from the HAD HQs or

the DoJ.

2.33. You should complete and sign PART IV of each Nomination Form.

2.34. You should decide the validity of each nomination as soon as practicable and not later than **10 December 2026**, except those nominations pending advice from the Police, the ORO or the CSD.

2.35. Upon your decision on the validity of nomination, you should –

(a) replace PART IV of the public inspection copy of the nomination form with a copy of signed PART IV of the form; and

(b) generate the form HAD/R3 from RREMIS to notify the candidate of your decision on the validity of his/her nomination; and

(c) generate the form HAD/R4 from RREMIS to notify each validly nominated candidate(s) of the Rural Area of your decision regarding the validity of all nomination(s) as soon as practicable.

2.36. The notifications mentioned in paragraphs 2.35(b) and (c) must be sent to the **address** (for IIR election)/**PRA** (for ReR and KFR elections) and **correspondence address** (if provided), of each candidate concerned as given on his/her Nomination Form.

2.37. Should you decide that a candidate is not validly nominated, you should update the Candidate Nomination Table and send it to "&HAD/RRE Web Maint".

Note RO's decision on the validity of nominations cannot be questioned in any proceedings except by an election petition to the High Court in accordance with the Rural Representative (Election Petition) Rules (Cap. 576B).

Determination of the candidate number on the ballot paper

2.38. A lots drawing to be conducted by RO/ARO will be held on **11 December 2026** (or a date as specified by the RO) to determine the candidate number to be shown on the ballot paper. You should then use the form "**Notice of the Candidate Number on the Ballot Paper"** (HAD/R7) to notify each validly nominated candidate in the Rural Area of his/her name order.

2.39. The candidates or their election agents should collect from you their badges at the lots drawing session on **11 December 2026** (or a date as specified by the RO), or at the time of checking the printing proof of the ballot papers.

Gazette Notices

2.40. The HAD HQs will prepare the following Gazette Notices for your clearance and endorsement. Please complete the checking and provide any comment you may have to the HAD HQs by **14 December 2026**. The Gazette Notices are scheduled to be gazetted on **21 December 2026**.

(a) Notice of Duly Elected Candidates in Uncontested Election; and
(b) Notice of Failure of Election.

2.41. You should provide the HAD HQs with the information of the designated polling stations and counting stations for the contested Rural Areas by **noon of 8 December 2026**. The HAD HQs will then prepare the concerned Gazette Notice to be issued by DHA for your clearance **in the morning of 10 December 2026**. Please complete the checking and provide any comment by **noon of 11 December 2026**. The Gazette Notice is scheduled to be gazetted on **21 December 2026**.

2.42. After the lots drawing session to be held on **11 December 2026**

(or a date as specified by the RO), the HAD HQs will prepare the Gazette Notice of all validly nominated candidates of the relevant Rural Area for your clearance and endorsement **in the morning of 14 December 2026**. Please complete the checking and provide any comment by **noon of 15 December 2026**. The Gazette Notice is scheduled to be gazetted on **21 December 2026**.

2.43. You should also upload the soft copy of the finalised location maps of the polling stations onto RREMIS by **9 December 2026** so that HAD HQs could send the maps, together with the polling notices, to the electors at least 10 days before the polling day as required under the law. Please also sign and certify all the printed location maps and return to Miss Ronnie LI, LO(1)11 by email (email address: Ronnie HY LI/HAD/HKSARG@HAD) by **11 December 2026**.

Variation on the validity of nominations

2.44. If after you have made a decision that a particular candidate is validly nominated for election, but before or on the date of the election, it is proved to your satisfaction that the candidate has died/is disqualified, you should -

(a) endorse on PART V of the nomination form of the deceased/disqualified candidate that (in the case of death of candidate) he/she has died; or that (in the case of disqualification of candidate) your earlier decision is varied to the effect that the candidate is not validly nominated and the reason(s) for the disqualification; and update the Candidate Nomination Table in the RRE website.

(b) declare that the candidate has died, or declare the variation of your decision as soon as practicable by any of the following means –

(i) publishing a notice in the Gazette;

(ii) publishing a notice in any daily newspaper in circulation in Hong Kong;

(iii) making a public announcement by radio or television; or

(iv) other means as you consider appropriate in the circumstances.

2.45. You should, if practicable, send a copy of the notice to each candidate who remains validly nominated for the Rural Area concerned to replace the notifications mentioned in paragraph 2.35(c) above. Please refer to **Appendix VIII "Contingency plans in respect of the Death or Disqualification of a Validly Nominated Candidate before or on the Polling Day"** for details.

Part IV Correspondence addresses of candidates

2.46. For IIR election, a candidate can fill in his/her office or business address, correspondence address, residential address or post office box number as address in the Nomination Form. He/she can provide his/her correspondence address (if different from his/her address). For ReR and KFR elections, the candidate can only provide correspondence address if there is no postal service available for his/her PRA. Correspondence to a candidate, including the notification on validity of nomination (see paragraph 2.35) should also be sent to his/her correspondence address.

Part V Campaigning activities

2.47. Chapter 7 "Election Advertisements", Chapter 8 "Electioneering Activities in Buildings where Electors Reside, Work or Frequent" and Chapter 9 "Election Meetings" of the **Guidelines** provide useful advice to help you monitor the campaigning activities. Please also note Chapter 7 of the **Guidelines** concerning

canvassing activities in a penal institution or the premises of a law enforcement agency ("LEA").

2.48. In case of doubt, you may seek advice from the HAD HQs and EAC Secretariat.

Unauthorized EA display

2.49. The "Action Checklist regarding Designation, Allocation and Enforcement in respect of Display of Election Advertisements" provides details of the conditions for display of EAs and the procedures for the removal of unauthorized EAs. You should arrange to remove any unauthorized EAs or any EAs displayed not in compliance with the relevant law and **Guidelines**. Your attention is drawn particularly to Chapter 7 of the **Guidelines** which states: "Candidates using the designated spots must read in detail and comply with the 'Conditions for Display of Election Advertisements at Designated Spots', which will be included in the candidate's folder and uploaded to the RR Election website (www.had.gov.hk/rre). To safeguard the safety of road users, candidates must ensure that EAs displayed do not distract motorists or interfere with the sight lines of motorists and pedestrians, or obscure any traffic signs or traffic light signals in a manner that obstructs the mobility of pedestrians."

2.50. After the removal of unauthorized EAs, you should issue a provisional warning letter to the candidate concerned in accordance with the "Action Checklist regarding Designation, Allocation and Enforcement in respect of Display of Election Advertisements".

2.51. No designated spot will be allocated to uncontested candidates. Contested candidates are required to remove all their EAs displayed in the designated spots **within 10 days** after the polling day, i.e. not later than **27 January 2027 (for IIR and ReR elections) or 3 February 2027 (for KFR election)**.

2.52. If you are aware that any candidate does not comply with the above requirement, you should coordinate with the relevant

government departments (FEHD, LCSD, HD, LandsD or HyD) to take removal action. Where applicable, the relevant department(s) would claim the removal cost from the candidates concerned.

2.53. You should remind the relevant government departments to issue all demand notes of removal cost not later than **21 days** after the date on which all elections in relation to the same Rural Committee are settled[1] for settlement of bills. The candidates concerned can then include the settled sum in his/her "**Return and Declaration of Election Expenses and Election Donations**" (HAD/C1) and submit it to the DHA via you by the statutory deadline as required under s.37 of Cap. 554.

Part VI No Canvassing Zone ("NCZ") and No Staying Zone ("NSZ")

2.54. The candidates should receive from you the location maps and layout plans of the polling stations, counting stations and BPSS within 14 days (i.e. on or before **21 December 2026**) after the end of nomination period.

2.55. You should issue a Notice (HAD/R19), together with the endorsed plans and relevant notice of the NCZ and NSZ (HAD/R9), to all candidates **not later than 2 days before polling day** requesting them to remove all of their EAs posted up at the private premises within the NCZ which can be seen by the electors on their way to the polling stations on the polling day, where there are private premises situated within the NCZ. Candidates should also be reminded that, if they put up EAs on the bodywork of public vehicles like buses or minibuses that might enter the NCZ on the polling day, they should arrange to remove such EAs before the polling day.

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[1] In accordance with s.37(1M) of Cap. 554, an election is settled on the date on which any of the following events occurs in relation to the election, or, if more than one of the following events occurs in relation to the election, on the date on which the last of those events occurs—
(a) the result of the election is notified in the Gazette;
(b) the proceedings for the election are declared to have been terminated;
(c) the election is declared to have failed.

2.56. The HAD HQs will conduct data matching with the CSD to ascertain the number of electors imprisoned or held in custody of a contested rural area. In case there is an elector imprisoned or held in custody, the HAD HQs will notify you and send the NCZ and NSZ plans of the DPS concerned to you for distribution to the candidates as soon as practicable. Starting from **28 December 2026**, the HAD HQs will keep updating the list of DPSs with electors through the RRE website for the candidates'/ polling agents' reference. The HAD HQs will send separate email to you with respect to any changes in the run-up to the polling day so that you would update the candidates concerned on the latest situation.

2.57. In case there is an imprisoned or remanded elector of a contested rural area after conducting data-matching on the Saturday preceding the polling day, special arrangement would be made by the HAD HQs to inform the candidates concerned of the latest position. They would be asked over the phone to furnish the HAD HQs with either a fax number or an email address so that the relevant plans could be sent to them instantly by the HAD HQs. The same set of documents will also be sent to your DLO by email for reference. If the relevant plans cannot be delivered to the candidates concerned by the aforesaid method, he/she would be asked to approach your DLO after 11:00 a.m. (for IIR and ReR elections) and 7:30 a.m. (for KFR election) on the polling day to collect the documents.

2.58. **"Notice of Variation of NCZ and NSZ"** (HAD/R10) must be given in writing to the candidates concerned as soon as practicable after the variation. However, a notice of variation need not be given to the candidates if it is not reasonably practicable to do so before the close of poll. A notice of variation may be given to the election agent or polling agent of the concerned candidates if present at the polling station.

2.59. On the polling day, you must display at or near the polling station a notice of the NCZ and NSZ (or a notice of variation of such zone(s), if applicable) to indicate the boundaries of those zones

in a manner that you think fit. You may perform such acts through a PRO.

2.60. If after display under paragraph 2.59, either or both of those zones are varied, you or the PRO must display at or near the polling station a notice of variation of the NCZ or NSZ or both those zones, if appropriate.

Part VII Candidate forms

2.61. A copy of the **"Action Checklist for Candidates"** ("the Action Checklist"), which is included in the Candidate's Folder, is attached at **Appendix IX** for your easy reference. To facilitate the candidates' compliance with the relevant electoral law, regulations and guidelines, various specified/ standard/ sample forms are prepared for their use. These candidate forms are listed in the Candidate's Folder.

2.62. Specified forms must be used by the candidates if applicable and should not be amended by candidates. Candidates should also be advised to use the standard forms provided by the HAD HQs, except the five forms mentioned in paragraph 2.63 below which can be suitably amended by candidates and/or other relevant parties. The submission method of each of the forms is listed at **Appendix X**.

2.63. For the following five forms, candidates or other relevant parties (e.g. candidates' supporters, owners, owners' corporations, owners' committees or property management bodies) may revise them to suit their own requirements, where appropriate, so long as the pertinent details are included –

(a)	Consent of Support given by Individual(s) in Personal Capacity or Official Capacity	HAD/C12A
(b)	Consent of Support given by in Organisational Capacity	HAD/C12B

(c)	Permission for Display of Election Advertisements or Conduct of Electioneering Activities at Private Premises	HAD/C13
(d)	Notification of Decision on Electioneering Activities	HAD/C19
(e)	Intention to Display Election Advertisements at Designated Spots	HAD/C21

2.64. Candidates may electronically upload and submit eight candidate e-Forms via the "Rural Representative Election e-Submission Platform". The e-Forms uploaded onto the platform by the candidates will be re-directed to the RREMIS and a notification email will be automatically sent to the email address of the RO of the relevant rural area. Please check your email inbox regularly to ensure the quick receipt of the e-Form. Upon receipt of the email, you should download the e-Form from the RREMIS and take follow-up actions accordingly.

Part VIII Submission of copies of EAs and relevant information

2.65. Part 10 of Cap. 541L and Chapter 7 of the **Guidelines** provide details on the requirements applicable to publication of EAs and submission of EA copies for public inspection.

2.66. If a candidate chooses to upload his/her EAs onto the Central Platform, he/she should follow the "Procedural Guide on Submission of Election Advertisements onto the Central Platform" at **Appendix XI**.

2.67. You can access the Central Platform at the link https://www.eaplatform.had.gov.hk/bd_hadea/logon/admin by

using the username and the two passwords provided by the HAD HQs to view the EAs uploaded by candidates. A "Procedural Guide on Using Central Platform (for RO)" is at **Appendix XII** for your reference.

2.68. If a candidate chooses to upload his/her EAs onto his/her Candidate's Platform, he/she must ensure that the Platform is an open platform accessible by the public. The electronic address of the Platform will be publicized on the Central Platform. The candidate should follow the basic layout requirements (including the need for providing the printing/publication details of the EAs and presenting the EAs in descending order of the date of submission) specified by the EAC at **Annex II** to **Appendix 4** of the **Guidelines** in building the Platform. The HAD HQs will issue reminder(s) to the candidate for any non-compliance and refer the case to you for follow-up if the non-compliance still persists despite our reminders. You may consider issuing warning letter to the candidate for a breach of the relevant law or referring the case to the Police for further investigation if no satisfactory representation is provided by the candidate.

2.69. The electronic copy of EA should be made available for public inspection on the Candidate's Platform or Central Platform in a manner that is clearly legible and readable, in accordance with s.92 of Cap.541L. In case you receive any complaint that the electronic copy of EA uploaded onto the Candidate's Platform or Central Platform is not legible or readable to the public, you should check the EA on the Platform. If the complaint is substantiated, you should explain to the candidate concerned that the submission is considered not having satisfied the requirement for the purpose of public inspection and should advise the candidate to upload another copy onto the Platform again. Please also copy the relevant correspondences with the candidate concerned to the HAD HQs.

2.70. Any unauthorized or offending EAs displayed may be seized, disposed of, destroyed, covered or obliterated by the RO or any person authorized by him/her under s.94 of Cap. 541L. As the

Central Platform is maintained by the HAD HQs, you may request the HAD HQs by completing and signing the Request Form (HAD/R23) to remove from the Central Platform any EAs containing content/information which is unlawful or not related to any EAs published by the candidate or which has been contaminated with computer virus after the submission. You should follow the procedures set out in Section C of the "Procedural Guide on Using Central Platform (for RO)" at **Appendix XII** if removal of EAs from the Central Platform is required. You should inform the candidate concerned of the reason for removal of the EA (HAD/R24) before the HAD HQs takes the removal action. If the EA is posted on a Candidate's Platform, you should inform the candidate concerned (HAD/R24) to remove the EA from the Platform as soon as possible while the other information/ document related to the EA should still be maintained at the Platform for public inspection.

2.71. If a candidate chooses to submit hard copy of the EA to your office, he/she should complete the form "**Information Sheet in relation to Election Advertisements**" (HAD/C10) and submit it together with two copies of the EA or two identical full colour photographs/printouts/photocopies of each EA which cannot be practically or conveniently produced in specie, or two identical copies of a CD-ROM/DVD-ROM containing the EAs, and a copy of permission/consent (if applicable) to you for public inspection. Where the information related to the EA provided to you contains a mistake, the candidate should complete and submit to you the "**Notification of Corrected Information in relation to Election Advertisements**" (HAD/C11) for public inspection.

2.72. Since a candidate is allowed to post an electronic copy of the EA onto the Central Platform or Candidate's Platform or submit a hard copy of the EA to your office for public inspection, you should inform the public who wish to inspect the hard copy of the EA that the candidate may also submit EAs via the Central Platform or Candidate's Platform and advise the public to visit the Platforms to view the other EAs of the candidate, if applicable. A sample note to the public provided by the HAD HQs for sticking onto the front cover of the EA folder is at

Appendix XIII. You are also required to inform the HAD HQs by returning the "**Notification of Submission of Hard Copy Election Advertisement by the Candidate**" (HAD/R21) whenever a candidate who has an account for Central Platform has submitted EAs in hardcopies so that we may publish the information at the Central Platform. The public may also inspect the EAs at RO's office if they wish. The HAD HQs will inform you whenever a candidate has registered for using the Central Platform or notified the DHA of the electronic address of the Candidate's Platform. You are advised to maintain a record of the information which should be attached to the EA folder so that the public can easily find out which candidates are using the Central Platform or Candidate's Platform.

2.73. The key time specified by the EAC relating to publication of the EAs are –

(a) copies of each EA and relevant information/documents must be posted onto the Central Platform/Candidate's Platform or submitted to the RO for public inspection **within 3 working days (i.e. any day other than a general holiday or Saturday) after publication of the EAs;**

(b) electronic address of Candidate's Platform must be provided to the RO **at least 3 working days before publication of the first EA;**

(c) corrective information must be posted onto the Central Platform/Candidate's Platform or submitted to the RO **3 working days after the polling day, the latest;** and

(d) statutory declaration giving the omitted printing details in the printed EAs must be submitted to the RO **not later than 7 days after the publication of the EAs concerned.**

Part IX Appointment of election, polling, counting and election expense agents

Types and numbers of agents

2.74. A candidate may appoint the following agents to assist in the election –

(a) one election agent;

(b) any number of election expense agents;

(c) not more than two polling agents for each polling station (other than a DPS situated in a penal institution) and not more than one polling agent for a DPS situated in a penal institution (other than a maximum security prison) subject to the consent of the CCS; and

(d) one counting agent for the counting station.

2.75. Subject to paragraphs 2.77, 2.78, 2.79, 2.80, 2.81 and 2.84, the appointment of an agent is not effective until you receive the notice of appointment.

2.76. Any person who is to be appointed as any of the above four types of agents must be at least 18 years old. In addition, except for the appointment of election expense agent, the person must be a holder of Hong Kong identity card.

Election agent

2.77. The appointment of an election agent may be made at any time after a candidate hands in his/her Nomination Form. If the "**Notice of Appointment of Election Agent**" (HAD/C6) is received before the close of nomination, you should send the "**Notice of Particulars of Election Agents**" (HAD/R8) to every other validly nominated candidate for the election concerned as soon as practicable after the close of nomination, and display a

copy of the Notice in a prominent place outside your office.

2.78. If the appointment of an election agent is made after the nomination period, or if a replacement is appointed, you must send the revised HAD/R8 to all candidates (except those who have been ruled invalid by you at that time) of the rural area concerned as soon as practicable after receipt of the notice of the appointment or replacement, as the case may be. The Notice displayed outside your office should also be updated accordingly.

Election expense agents

2.79. Only candidates and appointed **election expense agents** can incur election expenses. The authorization of election expense agents must be made in writing and in the specified form "**Authorization to Incur Election Expenses**" (HAD/C3).

Polling agents

2.80. If a candidate wishes to appoint polling agent(s) for polling station not situated in penal institutions, he/she should complete the "**Notice of Appointment of Polling Agents for a Polling Station not Situated in a Penal Institution**" (HAD/C7). The Notice must be delivered to you by hand, by post, by email or by fax at least 7 days before the polling day. For any such notice(s) delivered to you less than 7 days, the candidate or his/her election agent should be advised to deliver the notice(s) in person to the relevant PRO, as appropriate, on the polling day.

2.81. The "**Notice of Appointment of Polling Agent for a Dedicated Polling Station Situated in a Penal Institution (Other than a Maximum Security Prison) and Application for Consent to the Presence of Election Agent/Polling Agent in a Dedicated Polling Station Situated in a Penal Institution (Other than a Maximum Security Prison)**" (HAD/C20/DPS) must be delivered by hand, by post, by email or by fax to the DHA via the RO at least 7 days before the polling day, i.e. by **10 January 2027 (for IIR and ReR elections) and 17 January**

2027 (for KFR election). The appointment will not be effective unless the CCS consents to the appointment. Please see Chapter 6 of the **Guidelines** for details.

2.82. To facilitate the observing of the poll of electors in custody transferred or newly admitted to a penal institution within the week before polling day, the CCS shall have discretion to accept applications made within the week before polling day.

2.83. If you receive the "**Notice of Appointment of Polling Agent for a Dedicated Polling Station Situated in a Penal Institution (Other than a Maximum Security Prison) and Application for Consent to the Presence of Election Agent/Polling Agent in a Dedicated Polling Station Situated in a Penal Institution (Other than a Maximum Security Prison**" (HAD/C20/DPS), you should send an acknowledgment receipt (HAD/R20) to the applicant bearing an application number in specified format. The application number should be assigned according to the Rural Area code of the concerned Rural Area. For example, the application number of the first applicant of Chung Mei Tsuen should be DPS-S2-031-01, the second applicant is DPS-S2-031-02 and so on. You should then write down the application number in the application form and email the form to Mr. Adrian CHAN, LO(1)6 (email address: Adrian SC CHAN/HAD/HKSARG@HAD) immediately for onward transmission to the CSD. The CSD will announce the application result through the RRE website. The CSD will notify the applicant in writing only if the application is rejected.

Counting agents

2.84. The "**Notice of Appointment of Counting Agent**" (HAD/C8) should be delivered to you by hand, by post, by email or by fax before the 3 days preceding polling day(s), i.e. by **13 January 2027 (for IIR and ReR elections) and 20 January 2027 (for KFR election)**. For any such notice(s) delivered to you less than 3 days, the candidate or his/her election agent should be advised to deliver the notice(s) in person to the Officer-in-charge of the counting station on the polling day.

List of agents

2.85. HAD HQs will provide a list of election, polling and counting agents to the PRO and the ARO(BPSS) about one week before the polling day. You should input the details of the agents, including Chinese name, English name, HKID number and contact telephone number, into the RREMIS by **6 January 2027 (for IIR and ReR elections) and 13 January 2027 (for KFR election)**. If there is any change in the list of agents after the above-mentioned dates, you should notify the concerned PRO and ARO(BPSS) direct.

Part X Complaints handling

2.86. You should familiarize yourself with the complaints-handling procedures set out in Chapter 19 of the **Guidelines** and the "**Procedural Manual for Handling Election-related Complaints**" issued by the EAC which will be emailed to you by the REO.

Part XI Public inspection of documents

2.87. You should make available copies of the documents listed at **Appendix XIV** for public inspection.

2.88. Unless otherwise specified, you should cover all identity document types and numbers, date of birth (except the year), addresses, PRAs (except the region, district and rural area on the Nomination Forms for ReR and KFR elections), correspondence address, telephone number(s), fax number and email address (except contact information for the media and public on the Nomination Form) before display for compliance with the Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance ("PDPO") (Cap. 486).

2.89. The names and addresses (for IIR Election) / part of PRAs (for ReR and KFR Elections) of all validly nominated candidates as

shown in their Nomination Forms will be gazetted for public information. Candidates may also choose to provide their contact method(s) to the media and the public in the box "Contact Information for the Media and Public" on their Nomination Forms. Members of the public may approach the candidates to obtain other particulars relating to their nominations. Candidates may decide whether or not to provide their other particulars to the public.

2.90. A person who wishes to inspect the electoral forms or documents should sign an inspection form. A sample form is provided at **Appendix XV**. You should keep statistics of public inspection for future reference and a sample form is provided at **Appendix XVI**.

Part XII Essential services to be provided during ordinary business hours

2.91. Nomination forms should be made available for public inspection during the ordinary business hours. Under s.2 of Cap. 541L, "ordinary business hours (通常辦公時間)" means the hours –

(a) between 9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. on any Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday or Friday (other than a general holiday); and

(b) between 9:00 a.m. and 12:00 noon on a Saturday (other than a general holiday) during the period between –

(i) the date of publication of a notice under s.4(1) of Cap. 541L in respect of the RR Election (i.e. **13 November 2026**); and

(ii) the date of publication of the result of the election under Cap. 576 or the date of the declaration of the failure or termination of the election under that Ordinance, whichever is the later.

2.92. For other forms /documents, they should also be made available for public inspection at the RO Office. Please refer to **Appendix XIV** for details.

2.93. You should designate a staff to work on Saturdays (other than general holidays) during the following periods –

For uncontested election	:	**from 13 November to 21 December 2026**
For contested election (IIR and ReR elections)	:	**from 13 November to 22 January 2027**
For contested election (KFR election)	:	**from 13 November 2026 to 29 January 2027**

Part XIII Re-allocation of polling station for elector with a disability

2.94. Any electors with mobility difficulties, if being allocated a polling station not accessible to persons with mobility difficulties or other difficulties, can apply to you at least 5 days before the polling day for a re-allocation of polling station. If you receive such request, please inform Miss Ronnie LI, LO(1)11 by email (email address: Ronnie HY LI/HAD/HKSARG@HAD) **immediately** for processing.

Part XIV Exit poll

2.95. Exit polls may be conducted by any person aged 18 or above or any organisation in respect of any rural area. Applicants or applicant organisations intending to conduct exit polls in the RRE must complete and submit the prescribed application form with the following information to the ROs via the HAD at the latest **10 days** before the relevant polling day(s) –

(a) the name and address of the applicant or applicant organisation, as well as the name, identity document number (alphabet and the first 3 digits) of the person responsible for the exit poll and the phone number(s) at which he can be contacted during the polling hours;

(b) the purpose of conducting the exit poll; and

(c) a list of persons (not more than 15) (including names and HKID numbers (alphabet and the first 3 digits)) who will be deployed for the conduct of the exit poll at each polling station on the polling day(s).

2.96. The Application Form for Conduct of Exit Poll can be downloaded from the RRE website "http://www.had.gov.hk/rre".

2.97. Applicants/ Applicant organisations and the persons who will be deployed for the conduct of exit polls at the polling station must comply with all the requirements and guidelines for the conduct of exit polls promulgated by the EAC and the HAD. Chapter 14 of the **Guidelines** governs the conduct, publication and broadcast of exit polls. If applicants/ applicant organisations fail to comply with the requirements and guidelines, the approval to conduct exit poll on the polling day or during the polling hours may be revoked. If you receive such application, please forward it to the HAD HQs for follow-up action.

2.98. Applicants/ Applicant organisations will be notified in writing if the application is approved in principle. Applicants or applicant organisations should return the "Reply Slip of Confirmation" signed by each interviewer to the HAD HQs before the specified date and the application shall be formally approved as soon as possible.

2.99. Upon RO's approval, the HAD HQs will send you a notice showing the name of applicants or applicant organisations approved to conduct exit polls together with their contact telephone numbers. The notice will also be uploaded onto the RRE website prior to the polling day(s) for the reference of the

public and candidates. Such a notice will also be displayed at respective polling stations on the polling day(s).

2.100. The HAD HQs will notify the applicants or applicant organisations approved to collect a number of identification badges bearing the name of the relevant applicants/ applicant organisations. Each interviewer is required to wear the badges in a prominent position when conducting an exit poll. He/She must also adopt the "Standard Script for Interviewers Conducting Exit Poll" at the start of the interview in order to make known to the electors the name of the person or organisation conducting the exit poll, the exit poll is not commissioned by the Government and any response is entirely voluntary. Any person not wearing the badges prominently will not be allowed to conduct an exit poll outside any polling station.

2.101. Unless the conduct of exit poll is on a pedestrian pavement that is not under any private management in the NCZ, applicants/ applicant organisations must also separately seek the prior approval from the owners/ managers concerned by themselves before the exit poll can be conducted.

Chapter 3: Polling

- **The poll (Guidelines, Ch. 4)**
- **Postponement or adjournment of the poll**

Part I The Poll

3.1. On polling day, a Central Command Centre ("CCC") will be set up by the HAD HQs to monitor the poll and the count.

3.2. To facilitate effective and efficient communication, you will be provided with a telephone directory containing the contact numbers of all relevant parties on the polling day. You are required to keep close contact with the PRO(s) to ensure the maintenance of law and order in the polling station(s).

3.3. The following three types of polling stations will be set up for the election on the polling day –

(a) Ordinary Polling Station(s) situated near the Rural Area(s)

- For IIR and ReR elections, the polling hours will be from 12:00 noon to 7:00 p.m.

- For KFR election, the polling hours will be from 8:30 a.m. to 9:30 p.m.

(b) Dedicated Polling Station(s) (DPS) situated in a penal institution (subject to the result of data matching with the CSD)

- Such polling station(s) will cater for electors under the custody of CSD on the polling day.

- The polling hours will be from 1:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m.

- The number of registered electors who are imprisoned in individual penal institutions will be posted and updated on the RRE website "http://www.had.gov.hk/rre" every working day starting from **28 December 2026** and on the Saturday immediately before the polling day.

(c) DPS situated in Mei Tin Community Hall

- Such polling station will cater for the electors who are remanded or detained by the law enforcement agencies ("LEAs") except CSD on the polling day.

- For IIR and ReR elections, the polling hours will be from 12:00 noon to 7:00 p.m.

- For KFR election, the polling hours will be from 8:30 a.m. to 9:30 p.m.

The authority of the RO/PRO in keeping of order in the NCZ/NSZ/polling station

3.4. The PRO is to keep order at the NCZ, NSZ and polling station. At the NCZ, NSZ and polling station, if a person misconducts himself/herself or fails to obey a lawful order of the RO/PRO, the RO/PRO can immediately order that person to leave the NCZ, NSZ or the polling station. If that person fails to leave when being ordered to do so, the person may be removed by a police officer or by a person authorized in writing by the RO/PRO, as may be appropriate. If the NCZ or NSZ is determined in relation to a DPS or the polling station is a DPS, the person may also be removed by an officer of the CSD or any LEA.

Misconduct in NCZ/NSZ/polling station

3.5. Generally speaking, a person will be considered as misconducting himself/herself if he/she causes an obstruction to any person in the NCZ/NSZ and on his/her way to vote. Inside the polling station, a person misconducts himself/herself if he/she disrupts the poll, or disturbs or causes inconvenience to any person.

Part II Postponement or adjournment of the poll or the count

3.6. Under the existing statutory provisions, the election may be postponed and the poll or the count may be adjourned if it appears to the relevant authorities that the election/poll/count is obstructed, disrupted, undermined or seriously affected by –

(a) a typhoon or other climatic condition of a serious nature; or

(b) riot, open violence or any danger to public health or safety; or

(c) an occurrence which appears to the EAC to be a material irregularity relating to the election, the poll or the counting.

Procedure after postponement of the election or adjournment of poll or the count

3.7. As soon as you are informed by the CCC of the decision to postpone the election or adjourn a poll or the count, you should inform the candidates concerned of the postponement or adjournment. The CCC will also inform the PROs who will in turn inform the candidates, election agents, and polling agents, if any, who are present within the polling stations.

3.8. Upon receipt of the ballot boxes and relevant electoral materials from the PROs, you should –

(a) take charge of them and be responsible for their safety and security during the time when the electoral materials are in your custody; and

(b) take such steps as to be advised by the EAC (through the CCC) relating to the resumption of the postponed/adjourned poll.

3.9. For detailed arrangement in case of emergencies or inclement weather on the polling day, please refer to the **Appendix XVII**.

Chapter 4: Counting

- **Conduct of the count (Guidelines, Ch. 4)**
- **Declaration of election result**

Part I BPSS and Counting Station

BPSS

4.1. A BPSS will be set up on the polling day for sorting ballot papers cast at the DPSs, which will be delivered to respective counting stations for counting. The BPSS is presided by an ARO(BPSS).

Counting station

4.2. All polling stations, except the APSs and DPSs, will be converted into counting stations for the counting of votes.

4.3. After the close of poll, candidates, election agents, polling agents and counting agent are allowed to observe the physical conversion of the polling station into a counting station.

4.4. The PRO (for IIR and ReR elections)/ RO (for KFR election) is responsible for supervising the counting station and the counting of votes.

4.5. You should use the "**Notice of the Time and Place of the Count and Sorting of Ballot Papers**" (HAD/R15) to notify each candidate of the Rural Area in writing of the place and name of the counting station and the BPSS, as well as the time for the counting and sorting of votes after the gazettal of designation of counting stations on **21 December 2026.** In any event, the notice should reach the candidate at least 10 days before the polling day.

4.6. Government counsel will be appointed as ARO(Legal) to advise RO/PRO on the interpretation of law, including the determination of validity of ballot papers, etc.

4.7. No person may film, take photographs or make any audio or video recording within the counting zone of a counting station (including BPSS) without the express permission of the Officer in-charge of the counting station, DHA or any member of the EAC.

4.8. No person, except those stipulated in s.58(3) of Cap. 541L may enter or stay in the counting zone without the written authorization of the PRO, RO or any member of the EAC.

Part II "First Past the Post" Voting System

4.9. RO/PROs are reminded that in this Rural Ordinary Election –

(a) the "first past the post" system is adopted;

(b) a ballot paper must be marked by using the chop with a tick " √ " provided by the HAD HQs. No other alternative means of marking will be accepted; and

(c) samples of valid and invalid ballot papers will be provided to you later.

Part III Election Result

Counting result reported by PRO

4.10. When the counting of votes has been completed (the result of which has been made known to the candidates or their agents present) and there is no request for a re-count or such request is rejected by the PRO or the re-count is completed and there is no request for a further re-count or the request for a further

re-count has been rejected, the PRO will submit the result to the District Command Centre ("DCC").

4.11. After obtaining the counting result, DCC will verify the figures and prepare the **"Notice of Result of Election" (F9(IIR)/ F9(ReR)/K10(KFR))** for your signature.

Determination of results by drawing of lots

4.12. In the event that two or more candidates obtain equal highest number of votes and the number of such candidates exceeds the number of vacancies to be filled, the RO must determine the result of the election by drawing lots. You should use the means of contact provided by such candidates on their nomination forms to request them to come to a place as determined by you for conducting the drawing of lots. If you fail to contact any of such candidate(s)/representative(s) of the candidates (i.e. election agent(s)) or any of them does not show up after a reasonable time, you may draw lots on behalf of the candidate(s) in front of others. You should openly announce on which candidate's behalf you are going to draw the lot before the actual drawing.

4.13. The procedures for drawing lots are as follows –

(a) 10 table-tennis balls each marked with a number from 1 to 10 will be put into an empty opaque bag; and

(b) each of the above-mentioned candidates is to take turn (in the order in which the candidates' names are listed on the ballot paper) to draw a ball from the bag and let you record the number of the ball, then <u>return it to the bag</u>;

(c) For one vacancy to be filled –

i. where there are two such candidates, the candidate/representative who draws the larger

number will be the winner (1 is the smallest number and 10 is the largest number); and

ii. where there are more than two such candidates, if in the first draw, the numbers drawn by them are different, then the candidate/representative who draws the largest number will win. If on the other hand, two or more of the candidates/ representative(s) has/have drawn a smaller number, there must be a second draw. Only those candidates/representatives who have drawn the same larger number in the first draw will participate in the second draw;

(d) For two vacancies to be filled –

i. where there are three candidates having equal number of votes, if the three candidates/ representative(s) have drawn respectively the largest, the larger and the smallest numbers, the two candidates/representative(s) who have drawn the largest and the larger numbers should be successful in getting the two vacancies, and the remaining candidate/representative will fail;

ii. if the three candidates have drawn respectively two larger equal and one smaller numbers, then again the two candidates/representative(s) who have drawn the larger equal numbers will be the winners to fill the two vacancies;

iii. if the three candidates/representative(s) have drawn respectively a larger and two equal smaller numbers, the candidate/representative who has drawn the larger number will be successful and the remaining two candidates/representative(s) will participate in a second draw;

(e) the same principle will apply where there are N candidates having an equal number of votes and there are less than N vacancies to be filled.

Declaration of result

4.14. When the result is known, you should first inform the candidates/agents present that you will be announcing the result.

4.15. You should declare as elected the candidate who is successful at the election. Please see the suggested script at **Appendix XVIII**.

4.16. The duly signed "**Notice of Result of Election**" (Form F9/K10) should be –

(a) faxed to the following parties –

		Fax No.
(i)	PRO concerned (for displaying outside the counting station)	Please refer to the telephone list to be provided later
(ii)	CCC	Please refer to the telephone list to be provided later
(iii)	EAC and CEO (Attn: Duty Officer)	2511 1682
(iv)	SCMA (Attn: AS(CMA)2B)	2840 1976

(b) made copies for displaying at NTDOs, NTHAECs, and respective RCs.

4.17. After the count, the HAD HQs will prepare the Gazette Notice on Result of the Election for your clearance and endorsement. Please complete the checking and provide any comment by

6:00 p.m. on the day following the polling day, i.e. **18 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections) or 25 January 2027 (for KFR election)**.

Chapter 5: After Polling

* **Election expense limit (Guidelines, Ch.15)**
* **Return and declaration of election expenses and election donations (Guidelines, Ch.15)**
* **Return of the signed Rural Representative Oath**
* **Disposal of electoral documents (Guidelines, Ch. 4)**

Part I Maximum amount of election expenses

5.1. According to s.2 of the Maximum Amount of Election Expenses (Rural Representative Election) Regulation (Cap. 554B), the maximum amount of election expenses that can be incurred by or on behalf of a candidate is set out in the following table.

(a) for an election in respect of a Rural Area with not more than 1,000 electors	$18,000
(b) for an election in respect of a Rural Area with 1,001 to 5,000 electors	$28,000
(c) for an election in respect of a Rural Area with more than 5,000 electors	$38,000

Part II Return and declaration of election expenses and election donations

5.2. Soon after the polling day, you should send a letter (HAD/R22) to each candidate in a contested rural area to remind him/her to remove all EAs on government land/property still on display within the time specified in paragraph 2.51.

5.3. A candidate, whether elected or not, or who was returned uncontested, or who has withdrawn the candidature before the close of nominations, or has been decided by the Returning Officer as not validly nominated, or has not incurred any election expenses, must keep an accurate account of all election expenses incurred and election donations (whether in cash or in kind) received in the form of election return for submission to the DHA via the relevant RO. The letter (HAD/R22) serves the purpose of reminding the candidate to complete the **"Return and Declaration of Election Expenses and Election Donations"** (HAD/C1) ("Election Return") and lodge before the expiry of the period of 30 days after the date on which the last of the following events occurs in all RR elections in relation to the same Rural Committee to be held on the same date; or within such extended period as may be allowed by the CFI under the relevant law-

i. the result of the election is published in the Gazette;
ii. the proceedings for the election are declared to have been terminated;
iii. the election is declared to have failed.

5.4. You are also suggested to maintain a contact log **(Appendix XIX)** recording the follow-up actions with the candidate(s), if any, for reminding him/her to submit the Election Return before deadline.

5.5. The candidate can submit the election return to the respective RO at any time before the deadline. However, please advise him/her that if he/she wants to make any amendments of the submitted form, he/she is subject to the limitations under s.37A of Cap. 554.

5.6. You should help conduct the preliminary checking to the election returns submitted by the candidates before passing the returns to the HAD HQs, viz. –

(a) the **HAD/C1** form is duly signed;
(b) if any election expenses are more than $500 or above, the

election return must be accompanied by supporting invoices and receipts issued by the recipient of the payments;

(c) if any election donations are more than $1,000 or above, the election return must be accompanied by a copy of the receipt issued to the donor; and

(d) if the candidate has given his/her election donation to a charitable institution or trust of a public character, the election return should be accompanied by a copy of the receipt given by each recipient organisation.

5.7. You should make a copy of the election return for public inspection. All personal data (except the name(s) and address(es) of the donor(s)) in the election return should be covered before display. The original copies of the election return with the photocopy of "Information Sheet in relation to Election Advertisements" (HAD/C10) and "Notification of Corrected Information in relation to Election Advertisement" (HAD/C11) should be forwarded to the HAD HQs for further checking. The HAD HQs will check the election returns and refer any irregularities (e.g. errors, omissions, understatements, miscalculations, unreasonable expenses, apparent breaches of the law, etc.) to the ICAC.

Part III Submission of Rural Representative Oath

5.8. The HAD HQs will send letter to each RR-elect to remind him/her to return the signed Rural Representative Oath, either in person or by hand, to the DHA through the relevant RO, within the period of 30 days beginning on the date of the publication of the result of election. The Oath submission deadline shall be on **19 January 2027** (for uncontested elections), **22 February 2027** (for contested IIR and ReR elections) or **1 March 2027** (for contested KFR elections).

Part IV Disposal of electoral documents

5.9. Subject to any election petition, you should keep the following electoral documents in safe custody –

(a) All nomination forms;
(b) Notice(s) of Withdrawal of Candidature (if any);
(c) Authorization/Revocation of Authorization to Incur Election Expense;
(d) Notice(s) of Appointment/Revocation of Election Agent/Polling Agent/Counting Agent (if any);
(e) Information Sheet in relation to Election Advertisements;
(f) Consent of Support;
(g) Permission for Display of Election Advertisements or Conduct of Electioneering Activities at Private Premises;
(h) Undertaking on the Use of Electors' Information;
(i) Notice for Collection of Electors' Information (Soft copy of postal address);
(j) Undertaking on the Use of Electors' Information (Soft copy of postal address);
(k) Notification of Decision on Electioneering Activities; and
(l) Intention to Display Election Advertisements at Designated Spots.

5.10. The HAD HQs will seek blanket approval from the Government Record Service for disposal of these election documents and will keep you informed of the arrangement.

Part V Confirmation of Destruction of Relevant Electors' Information

5.11. If a candidate has obtained a hard copy and/or a soft copy of the electors' information from you as mentioned under paragraph 2.16(2) above, he/she should ensure proper erasure and destruction of all the electors' personal data or return the relevant materials (if any) to you, and return the duly completed "Reply Slip on Confirmation of Destruction of Relevant Electors' Information" (HAD/C16b) within two weeks after the election, i.e. by **1**

February 2027 (for IIR and ReR elections) or by **10 February 2027** (for KFR elections).

5.12. If the candidate fails to return the relevant reply slip on the confirmation of destruction of the materials/information to the RO within the above specified date, such materials/information should be regarded as lost. Since the electors' information contained in the relevant materials/information will be exposed to the risk of unauthorized or accidental access, processing, erasure, loss or use, you should report the case to HAD HQs and follow the recommendation of the "Guidance on Data Breach Handling and the Giving of Breach Notifications" which was issued by Office of the PCPD to report the incident to the PCPD and the relevant law enforcement agencies (e.g. the Hong Kong Police Force) so as to protect the personal data privacy and the interests of the data subjects concerned.

Action Checklist for Returning Officer

11 November 2026	**Nomination Forms** Receive Nomination Forms and Candidate Forms (1st batch) from the HAD HQs.
13 November to 7 December 2026	**Nomination** - Make available nomination forms to the public. - Notify the public of the date and time for receiving nominations by displaying a notice in the lobby/entrance of RO's office, NTHAECs, NTDO Notice Boards at Rural Areas concerned, and copy to the Rural Committees concerned.
From 18 November 2026 onwards	**Candidates' Form** 1. Receipt of Forms and Make Forms Available for Collection and Inspection. Please refer to **Appendix XIV** for details. 2. Electioneering Activities/EAs: - Receive notifications from various bodies having control of private premises about their decisions regarding campaigning activities in their buildings. - Receive from candidate(s) a copy each of all authorizations issued by private building for EA display. - Receive from candidate(s) a copy of information sheets in relation to EAs, or notifications of corrected information if applicable, together with two hard copies of each EA (or two identical full colour photographs/ printouts/ photocopies of each EA which cannot be

	practically or conveniently produced in specie, or two identical copies of a CD-ROM/DVD-ROM containing the EAs), if candidates choose such method of submission instead of uploading them onto the Central Platform or the Candidate's Platform. - Receive from candidate(s) consent of support forms (C12A) and (C12B) or written permission obtained from any person/ government department/ organisation regarding the EAs concerned, if applicable. 3. Public Inspection: - Make available one copy each of "Information Sheet in relation to Election Advertisements"/ "Notification of Corrected Information in relation to Election Advertisements", samples of EAs, permission or authorization for EA display, "Consent of Support", and forms related to the appointment/revocation of election expenses agents for public inspection. Cover all identity document numbers, telephone numbers and residential addresses of agent/witness (if any) before display. - Stick a sample note **(Appendix XIII)** onto the front cover of the EAs folder to inform the public that the candidate may also submit EAs particulars via the Central Platform/Candidate's Platform.
11 November 2026	**Candidate's Folder** Receive Candidate's Folders from the HAD HQs.
Before 24 November 2026	**Designated spots**

	- Draw up the list of designated spots on the Government Land/Property for all Rural Areas and obtain prior approval form the relevant government departments for all these spots. - Receive and consider any suggestions made by prospective candidates on the designated spots for EA display. - Make ready at hand the lists of the general locations of designated spots and distribute the respective list to concerned candidates upon their requests when receiving their nomination forms.
From 24 November to 7 December 2026	**Nomination Period** 1) Receive and vet the following from each candidate: - nomination form (The checklist for vetting nomination form is at **Appendix III**) - completed Grid Paper (HAD/C17a) (one colour photograph of the candidate taken within the last six months should be affixed to the completed grid paper together with two additional identical colour photographs) (The checklist for vetting Grid Paper is at **Appendix VI**) - completed "**Intention to Display Election Advertisements at Designated Spots**" (HAD/C21). 2) Give each candidate a Candidate's Folder upon receipt of his/her Nomination Form. 3) Remind candidate: a) Notes to Candidates (**Appendix VII**) b) if he/she is a civil servant, read carefully CSB Circular No. 5/2014 (**Appendix IV**) c) if he/she is a HAD staff, read carefully HAD

	Standing Circular No. 6/2014 (**Appendix V**) d) the venue, date and time of the EAC Briefing for Candidates, the lots drawing session and the session of Checking Ballot Paper, Introduction to Candidates and Poster Printing Proofs by Candidates e) to email or fax their requests for collection of electors' information to the RO by **7 December 2026** f) to submit the "Form for Submission of a Text Version of Introduction to Candidates for Electors and Authorized Representatives with Visual Impairment" by email by 5:00 p.m. on **21 December 2026** 4) Input the candidate's information and scan a copy of the Nomination Form, Supplementary Sheet for Subscribers (if any) and HKIC into the RREMIS immediately after completing the receipt process of each nomination (in any case, the task should be done no later than 6:00 p.m. on weekday and 12:30 p.m. on Saturday). 5) Complete and fax the "**Daily Return on the Number of Nomination Form Received**" (HAD/R2) by 6:00 p.m. (on weekday) and by 12:30 p.m. (on Saturday) to the HAD HQs. 6) Update the Candidate Nomination Table daily and send it to "&HAD/RRE Web Maint". 7) Notify the HAD HQs, REO and other validly nominated candidate(s) concerned about withdrawal of candidature, if any, by faxing/sending the completed "**Notice of Withdrawal of Candidature**" (HAD/R5 and HAD/R6).
From 24 November to 9	**EAC Briefing for Candidates**

December 2026	Fax or email the reply slip to HAD HQs daily attention to Miss Ellen WONG, PM(1)4 (fax: 3156 1486 or email address: Ellen MS WONG/HAD/HKSARG@HAD) if the candidate indicates that he/she would attend the EAC Briefing at HAD HQ.
From 24 November to 10 December 2026	**Validity of Nominations** - Determine the validity of each nomination received. - Send a notice (HAD/R3 & HAD/R4) of RO's decision to the address/PRA and correspondence address (if any) of each validly nominated candidate. Scan a copy of HAD/R3 into RREMIS.
From 24 November 2026 until the gazettal of election result	**Public Inspection of Nomination Form** - Make a copy of each Nomination Form available for public inspection during the ordinary business hours (i.e. from 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. on weekdays and from 9:00 a.m. to 12:00 noon on Saturdays) between 24 November and the date of the publication of election result. Deploy a staff to work during lunch hour and on Saturdays during the above-mentioned period. - Cover all identity document numbers, date of birth (except the year), addresses, PRA (except the Region, District and name of Rural Area) (for ReR and KFR elections), correspondence address, telephone number(s), fax number, email address (except contact information for the media and public) on the Nomination Form.
From 24 November 2026 onwards	**Agents** - Receive the completed form(s) regarding appointment/revocation of appointment of election agents/ polling agents/counting agents/election expenses agent.

	- Send "Notice of Particulars of Election Agents" (HAD/R8) to each candidate (except candidate who has been ruled invalid) and display outside your office a copy of the notice. - If a candidate submits a notice (HAD/C20/DPS) to appoint a polling agent or an election agent to enter the DPS situated in a penal institution (other than a maximum security prison), you should send an acknowledgement receipt (HAD/R20) to the candidate and fax the notice to the HAD HQs (fax no.: 2591 6392) for onward transmission to CSD. - Check your email inbox daily to see any e-Form submitted by the candidate via "RRE e-Submission Platform".
From 24 November 2026 to 10 March 2027	**Complaint** Submit a statistical report on election-related complaints to the EAC Complaints Committee & the HAD HQs by noon every Wednesday during the complaints-handling period (i.e. from **24 November 2026 to 10 March 2027**).
From 25 November to 8 December 2026	**Grid Paper** Vet and deliver completed grid paper(s) with two attached photographs to the HAD HQs **daily.**
By noon of 8 December 2026	**Polling and Counting Station** Submit the finalised designation of the polling station(s) and counting station(s) to the HAD HQs.

From 10 to noon of 11 December 2026	**Gazette Notices** Check the Gazette Notices with polling details, including the designation of polling stations and counting stations.
From 11 to 14 December 2026	**Gazette Notices** Check and endorse the following Gazette Notices: - Notice of Duly Elected Candidates in Uncontested Election. - Notice of Failure of Election.
On or before 14 December 2026	**Designated spots** - Co-ordinate with the relevant departments to clear all unauthorized displays at designated spots for each Rural Area. - Co-ordinate the marking and numbering of designated spots with stickers on site. May consider spot check on the stickers, especially in rainy days, to ensure the stickers are in proper condition. - All stickers are to be placed on site by **13 December 2026** the latest.
9 December 2026	**Deployment of Electoral Staff** Finalised staff deployment plan for DCC and polling/counting stations (via email).
11 December 2026	**Lots drawing** - Attend the lots drawing session to (i) allocate designated spots for EA display; (ii) determine the candidate number to be shown on the ballot paper,

	and (iii) distribute the badges for candidates and their agents. Send the form "Notice of the Candidate Number on the Ballot Paper" **(HAD/R7)** to the candidates after the lots drawing.
From 14 to noon of 15 December 2026	**Gazette Notices** Check the Gazette Notice on validly nominated candidates.
9 December 2026	**Submission of Returns** - Location map of polling station(s) (via RREMIS). - Inventory List (via RREMIS).
From 17 December to 21 December 2026 or a time as specified by RO	**Checking of Printing Proof by Candidates** Arrange the session(s) for checking the printing proofs of ballot papers, Introduction to Candidates and posters by the candidates. Return checked proofs to HQ immediately after 5pm on 22 December 2026.
On or before 21 December 2026 (within 14 days after expiry of nomination period)	**Location Maps and Layout Plans** Distribute/send the location maps and layout plans of the polling station, counting station and BPSS to candidates.
From 4 December 2026 to 7 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections); or 14 January 2027 (for KFR election)	**Counting Station** Distribute/send the completed "**Notice of the Time and Place of the Count and Sorting of Ballot Papers**" (HAD/R15) to the candidate or his/her election agent or counting agent.

(At least 10 days before polling day(s))	
From 21 December 2026 to 14 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections); or 21 January 2027 (for KFR election) (Not later than 2 days before polling day)	**Notice of NCZ and NSZ** Issue a "**Notice on Removal of EAs Displayed within NCZ**" (HAD/R19) together with the endorsed/completed plans and relevant notice of the NCZ and NSZ (HAD/R9) to candidates.
From 21 December 2026 to 19 January 2027	**Rural Representative Oath** - Receive RR Oaths from RRs-elect for rural areas of uncontested elections. - Submit weekly return to HAD HQs.
From 21 December 2026 to the polling day	**Displaying of Publicity Banner / Poster** Display banner(s) and poster(s) at the Rural Area where contested election will be held.
11 December 2026	**Submission of Returns** - PRO Information Sheet (via email). - Map of NCZs and NSZs (via RREMIS). - Layout plan of polling/counting station(s) (via RREMIS). - Budget for setting up the polling/counting station(s) (via email).
6 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR electios); or 13	**Agent** - Input the details of the election/counting/election

January 2027 (for KFR election)	expense agents appointed by the candidates into the RREMIS. - If any appointment/revocation notification received after 6 January 2027 or 13 January 2027. RO should notify the PRO and ARO(BPSS) direct.
From 6 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections); or from 13 January 2027 (for KFR election)	**Election materials** Receive the election materials delivered from HAD HQs to the polling-cum-counting stations and District Emergency Depots.
On or before 12 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections); or 19 Janaury 2027 (for KFR election) (At least 5 days before polling day(s))	**Electors with mobility difficulties** - Receive the requests from the electors with mobility difficulties for re-allocation of polling station. - Inform the HAD HQs on the request(s) from the elector(s) so that another polling notice with location map of Alternative Polling Station (Disable) will be issued to the elector(s) concerned.
On or before 15 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections); or 22 January 2027 (for KFR election) (At least two days before polling day)	**Polling and Counting Station** 1) Set up polling/counting stations: - Install additional illumination. - Install ramp for disabled. - Hire mobile toilets. 2) Issue an authorization letter signed by the RO to those persons who are allowed to enter and remain in the polling station (HAD/R18) or counting zone of a counting station (HAD/R13). 3) Liaise with the Police for assistance in keeping order at the polling station(s), NCZ & NSZ as well as escorting the ballot box from the polling station(s) to the counting station, if necessary.

	4) Arrange vehicle for transporting the ballot box from the APS(s) (if any) to the counting station(s); and from the counting station(s) to CCC (depending on circumstances).
For IIR & ReR elections: 15 January 2027 (from 1800 to 2100) and 16 January 2027 (from 1200 to 2100) For KFR election: 22 January 2027 (from 1800 to 2100) and 23 January 2027 (from 1200 to 2100)	**Clearance of Unauthorized EAs** - Handle complaints received during the non-office hours. - Form a clearance team to handle unauthorized display of EAs.
Polling Day (17 or 24 January 2027)	**Polling and Counting** - Oversee the conduct of poll and count. - Prepare and sign the "Notice of Result of Election" **(F9)/(K10)** when the result is known and declare the election result at your office. - Fax the signed "Notice of Result of Election" **(F9)/(K10)** to the PRO for display outside the counting station. - Fax the signed "Notice of Result of Election" **(F9)/(K10)** to the HAD HQs for preparing the press release and Gazette Notice.

One day after the polling day	**Election Result** Check and endorse the draft Gazette Notice on Result of the Election.
One to two days after polling day	**EAs and Election Return** Send **HAD/R22** to remind candidates: - to remove all EAs on government land/property still on display within 10 days after the polling day - to submit "Return and Declaration of Election Expenses and Election Donations" **(HAD/C1)** **Honorarium for DCC Electoral Staff** - Submit the P(1) form for the DCC electoral staff to the HAD HQs.
From 22 January to 22 February 2027	**Rural Representative Oath** - Receive RR Oaths from RRs-elect for Villages of contested elections. - Submit weekly return to HAD HQs.
27 January 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections); or 3 February 2027 (for KFR election) (10 days after the polling day)	**Removal of EAs** Coordinate with relevant government departments to remove all EAs which remain on display at designated spots.

From 29 January to 1 March 2027	**Rural Representative Oath** - Receive RR Oaths from RRs-elect for Market Town(s) of contested elections - Submit weekly return to HAD HQs
1 February 2027 (for IIR & ReR elections); or 10 February 2027 (for KFR election) (within two weeks after the polling day)	**Confirmation of destruction of electors' information** Receive the hard copy and/or a soft copy of the electors' information (if any) and the reply slips from candidates on confirmation of destruction of electors' information.
On or before 21 days after the date on which all elections in relation to the same Rural Committee become settled	**Demand Note for Removal of EAs** Remind the government departments concerned to issue all demand notes for EA removals to candidates concerned.
On or before 10 February 2027	**Removal of stickers on designated spots** Arrange for removal of stickers on designated spots.
Within 30 days after the date on which all elections in relation to the same Rural Committee become settled	**Election Return** - Receive **"Return and Declaration of Election Expenses and Election Donations"** (HAD/C1) and send to the HAD HQs. - Make available a copy of the HAD/C1 submitted by candidates for public inspection.

15 March 2027	**Complaint** Submit a final statistical report of all complaint cases received during the complaints-handling period (i.e. from **11 November 2026 to 10 March 2027**) to the EAC.

Important	All electoral documents and their copies containing personal data should be kept in a steel cabinet fitted with locking bar and padlock when not in use. You are advised not to store personal data on any portable device unless otherwise deemed necessary for operational needs. Strong encryption and strong password (i.e. at least 8 characters with mixed-case alphabetic characters, numerals, and special characters) should be used for authentication before accessing data stored on portable devices, which must be kept in physically protected areas when not in use. You are reminded to remove the personal data from the portable devices once finished using.